Training Manual for the BWC-UNCSW Capacity Building Programme (2025-2026)

Training Manual was prepared by BWC

Preface

by the Chairperson

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Chairperson of Black Womxn Caucus

This training manual has been developed to guide the BWC-UNCSW Feminist Capacity Building Programme, which is designed to strengthen participants' skills and knowledge in feminist leadership, advocacy, and policy influencing, with a specific focus on the UNCSW processes and global gender equality agendas. It provides participants with a structured foundation for understanding how international frameworks connect to feminist organising, civil society participation, and practical action.

This is our first training manual, developed after two cohorts successfully went through the BWC-UNCSW Capacity Building Programme. As a programme commitment maker at the Generation Equality Forum under the category of "Youth-led Organizations", and having trained two cohorts of participants from different backgrounds, we recognised the need to document and strengthen our training approach. This manual therefore serves as a tool to improve the quality, consistency, and impact of our capacity building programme.

The manual introduces key frameworks and processes, including the Generation Equality Forum, the Action Coalitions, Beijing+30, the Compact on Women, Peace and Security and Humanitarian Action, and the CSW70 priorities. These sections are intended to help participants understand the global systems that shape gender equality work, while also reflecting on how these frameworks relate to their own contexts, organisations, and advocacy priorities.

Essentially this manual recognises that feminist leadership is not only about knowledge of global processes, but also about the ability to use that knowledge strategically. Participants are encouraged to engage critically with the content, reflect on the lived realities of women and girls, and identify opportunities to influence policy, strengthen accountability, and advance gender justice. Through this programme, participants are supported to move from understanding to action, contributing meaningfully to feminist movements and gender equality agendas at local, national, regional, and global levels.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Black Womxn Caucus (BWC) is a youth-led, feminist, and intergenerational movement founded in 2017 at the University of the Witwatersrand in Johannesburg, South Africa. The movement was formed in response to the increasing prevalence of Gender Based Violence and Femicide (GBVF) against women and children (including LGBTQIA+, Gender non-conforming, and persons with disabilities - this is why we use womxn with an x) in South Africa.

BWC is a movement committed to creating a society free from violence through advocacy, public education, community mobilization, and policy development across diverse contexts. It works with a wide range of constituencies, including adolescents and youth in schools, higher education institutions, and those outside formal education, as well as working-class women in urban, peri-urban, informal settlement, and rural communities. Grounded in the lived realities of women who are survivors and potential victims, GBVF remains central to BWC's organizing. The movement advocates for comprehensive intervention strategies that address the economic, political, social, physical, geographical, and psychological dimensions of GBVF, recognizing how these intersect to sustain violence against women and children. Since its beginnings as a university-based initiative, BWC has grown into a national movement with continental and international reach, playing a leading role in shaping GBVF discourse in South Africa through pivotal actions such as the **#TheTotalShutdown** and **#SandtonShutdown marches.**

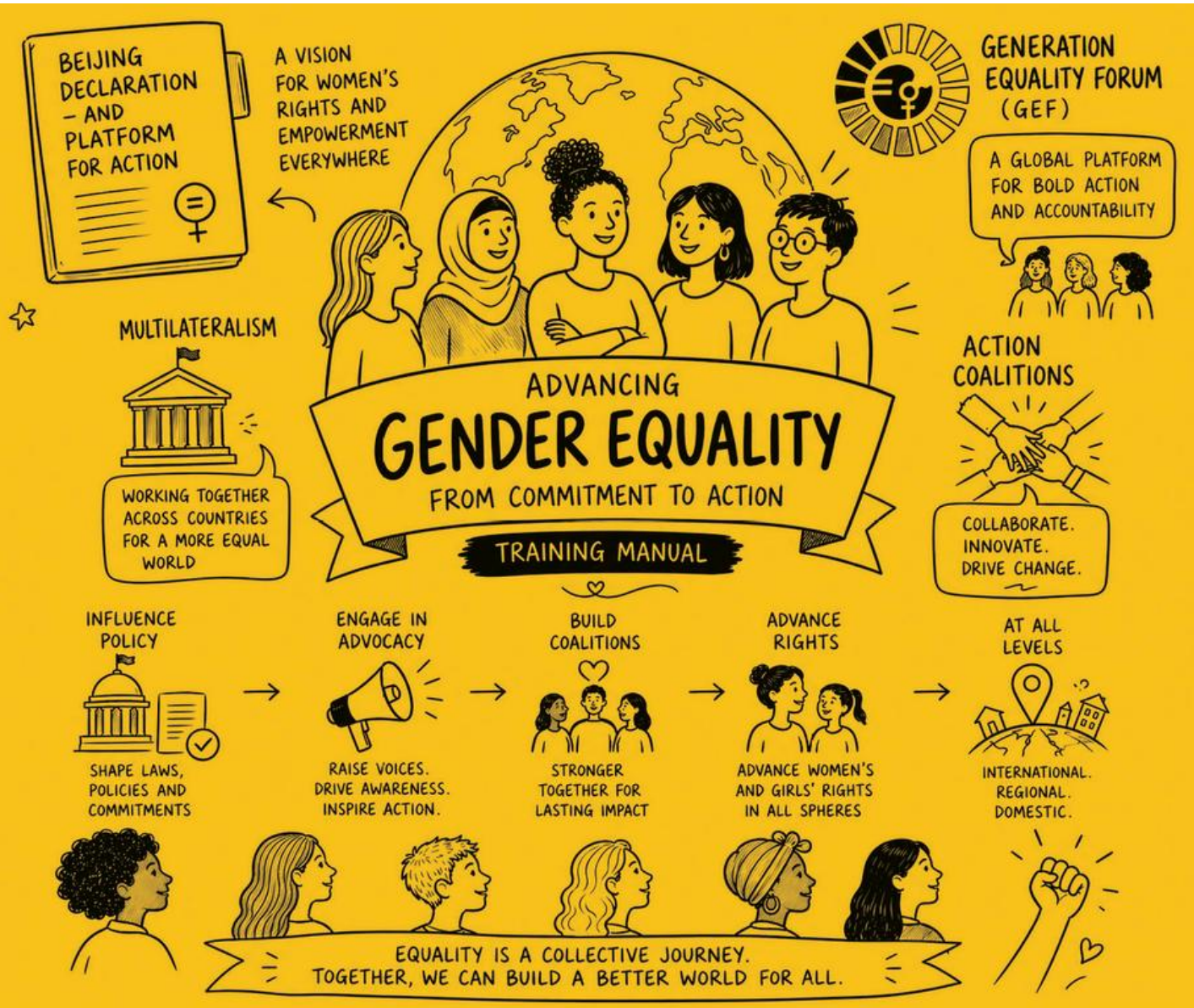
The United Nations Commission on the Status of Women (UNCSW) is a global intergovernmental body that was created in 1946 to promote gender equality and the empowerment of women in line with the UN Charter. The UNCSW is comprised of 45 member states elected by the Economic and Social Council. The main function of the UNCSW is to provide a global platform for policy development to advance the rights of women. The UNCSW plays a critical role in shaping global norms on gender equality, documenting the lived realities of women and girls globally, and monitoring progress in the implementation of key frameworks such as the 1995 Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action. Every year for two weeks in March, the UNCSW convenes to bring together governments, civil society organizations, and other actors to review progress, set priorities, and agree on a global agenda for women and girls. The main function of the UNCSW is to agree on well-informed conclusions that are policy recommendations to address challenges facing women and promote gender equality at the international, national, regional, and local levels. The main outcome is an Agreed Conclusions document that is submitted to the Economic and Social Council for follow-up and final approval. For more info read: Commission on the Status of Women (CSW).

BWC, as a civil society organization, has an important role to play at the UNCSW, where it contributes to shaping the country's national position, proposes or influences language for Agreed Conclusions, and builds coalitions with like-minded organizations to advance

women's rights and hold governments accountable. Leveraging its experience in high-impact national actions such as the **#TheTotalShutdown** and **#SandtonShutdown** marches, as well as community initiatives like **BWC Think Tank Sessions**, **#MakeMySchoolSafe**, and **Operation Letsa Phala**, BWC brings practical, evidence-based strategies to the global stage, strengthening civil society's voice and contributing to progress on gender equality.

Purpose of the Training Manual for the BWC-UNCSW Capacity Building Programme

This Training Manual provides guidance through the BWC-UNCSW Capacity-Building Programme, which is designed to equip participants with the knowledge, skills, and strategies needed to effectively engage with the UN Commission on the Status of Women. The programme provides participants with a comprehensive understanding of global gender equality frameworks, including the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, the Generation Equality Forum (GEF), multilateralism, and the Action Coalitions. Through this program, participants learn to influence national and global policy, engage in advocacy, build coalitions, and advance women's and girls' rights at international, regional, and domestic levels.



Programme Outline

Chapter/Session 2

Beijing 30+

- Explore the history and key developments of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action over the past 30 years, and discuss future targets and ongoing global engagements related to Beijing commitments.

Chapter/Session 3

Introducing the GEF

- Overview of the Generation Equality Forum, born out of Beijing 25+; examine the build-up negotiations, launch of the GEF, and lead countries; explain the relationship between GEF and the Beijing framework.

Chapter/Session 4

Action Coalition on Feminist Movements and Leadership

- Focus on strategies to strengthen feminist movements and leadership globally and locally.

Chapter/Session 5

Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence

- Address prevention, response, and policy advocacy to combat GBV.

Chapter/Session 6

Action Coalition on Economic Justice and Rights

- Explore economic empowerment, labour rights, and financial inclusion for women and girls.

Chapter/Session 7

Action Coalition on Bodily Autonomy and Sexual Reproductive Health Rights

- Examine policies, advocacy strategies, and legal frameworks to protect bodily autonomy and SRHR.

Chapter/Session 8

Action Coalition Feminist Action for Climate Justice

- Connect gender equality with climate justice, highlighting women's leadership in climate solutions.

Chapter/Session 9

Action Coalition on Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality

- Focus on leveraging technology and innovation to advance gender equality and close digital divides.

Chapter/Session 10

Compact on Women, Peace and Security and GEF Accountability Framework

- Focus on mechanisms for monitoring commitments and accountability within GEF and key find

Chapter/Session 11

Advancing Gender Equality through CSW70 Priorities

- Explores CSW70 priorities, with a focus on access to justice across social, economic, political, cultural, and digital systems.

Chapter/Session 12

Call to Action

Concludes the programme by encouraging participants to apply the learning, strengthen accountability, and contribute to gender equality in their contexts.

Chapter 2
Beijing+30 (history, developments, future targets and engagements around it)

Based on refs 2.1-2.2

Understanding Beijing+30

Beijing+30 marks the thirtieth anniversary of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, adopted by 189 governments in 1995. The Platform remains the most comprehensive global agenda for gender equality and the human rights of all women and girls. **Beijing+30 is therefore both a review moment and a call to accelerate action.** It asks a simple but urgent question: What progress has been made, what barriers remain, and what must happen next?

In 2025, the United Nations conducted the most comprehensive global stocktaking of progress on the Beijing Platform for Action to date, drawing on national, regional and global reviews, including contributions from 159 Member States. **This review confirmed two realities at once: there have been important gains for women and girls, but progress remains uneven, fragile and far too slow in many areas.**

The History Behind Beijing+30

The Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action emerged from the Fourth World Conference on Women in 1995. It set out a shared **global vision for gender equality and identified the steps needed to achieve it.**

Thirty years later, that vision remains highly relevant because gender equality is still essential to peaceful, prosperous and inclusive societies and to the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

Beijing+30 is therefore not just an anniversary. It is part of an ongoing process of review, accountability and renewal. It reminds governments, institutions and movements that past promises must be matched by implementation, investment and measurable results. The review also takes place in a much more difficult global context than 1995, shaped by economic instability, climate crisis, rising conflict, democratic erosion and backlash against gender equality.

What Has Changed Since Beijing?

The Beijing+30 review shows that there has been progress. Since 1995, **1,531 legal reforms around the world have sought to advance gender equality.** Women's representation in parliaments has more than doubled, more countries have laws against gender discrimination in employment, and many States have passed laws and created services to address violence against women and girls. Access to the Internet among women has also risen, and more countries are taking gender equality into account in climate and development planning.

At the same time, major inequalities remain. Women still have only about two-thirds of the legal rights of men globally. **Gender gaps in labour-force participation have stagnated for decades.** Maternal mortality declined sharply until 2015 but has since largely stalled. Billions of women and girls still lack social protection, and violence, poverty, exclusion from decision-making and unequal access to digital tools continue to affect women and girls in different and intersecting ways.

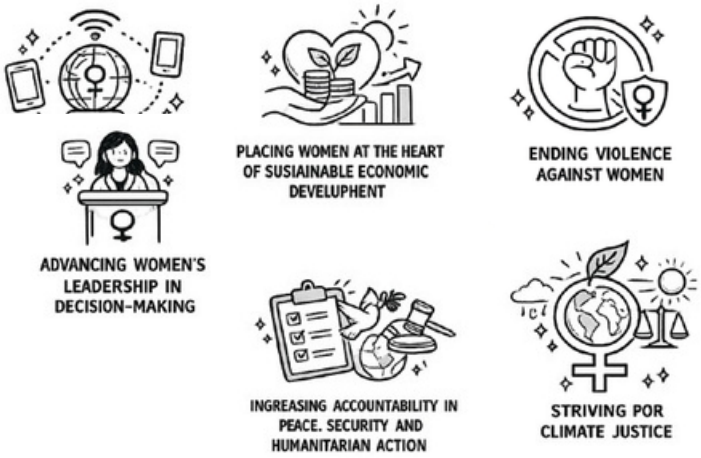
The review also highlights how recent crises have intensified these inequalities. COVID-19 worsened gender disparities, conflicts and humanitarian crises have expanded, climate change is undermining progress, and anti-rights actors are actively resisting gender equality. **In many countries, backlash is slowing or weakening implementation of the Beijing Platform for Action.**

What Beijing+30 Says Needs to Happen Now

The Beijing+30 review identifies five cross-cutting priorities for faster progress. First, it calls for closing the accountability gap by strengthening institutions, putting gender equality at the centre of policy and improving data. Second, it emphasizes elevating women's voices, including equal participation in decision-making and protection of civic space for women's groups. Third, it calls for closing the financing gap through stronger national investment and fairer global financial systems. Fourth, it highlights the need to harness technology by closing digital gender divides and addressing risks such as technology-facilitated violence. Fifth, it stresses the importance of shock-proof services and infrastructure so that crises do not reverse women's and girls' rights.

The Beijing+30 Action Agenda: Future Targets and Direction

In response to the review findings, UN-Women developed the Beijing+30 Action Agenda. At its centre is the "6+1" framework: six major action areas plus the cross-cutting inclusion of youth. The six action areas are:



The "+1" recognizes that adolescent girls and youth must be embedded across all priorities so that today's action shapes a more equal future.

The Action Agenda also sets out a three-pronged strategy to make Beijing+30 real. It seeks to support governments to commit to one or two actions aligned with national priorities and develop countryroadmaps; to strengthen the role of civil society by increasing resources and civic space; and to improve the effectiveness of the multilateral system through faster implementation of the Secretary-General's Gender Equality Acceleration Plan.

Two major foundations for change are emphasized across all of this work: financing for gender equality and mobilizing gender data. The review notes that an additional **$360 billion per year is needed globally** to achieve gender equality and women's empowerment by 2030. It also stresses that women's organizations need sustainable and flexible funding, and that better gender data are essential for policy, advocacy and accountability.

Engagement Around Beijing+30 in Africa

In Africa, engagement around Beijing+30 has been driven by regional consultations, youth participation, and civil society leadership. As part of the review process, FEMNET and NGO CSW Africa, in collaboration with UN Women, convened 13 civil society and youth consultations across the continent, engaging 3,136 participants from all five African subregions. These consultations brought together women's rights organisations, youth-led groups, and other stakeholders to assess progress, identify gaps, and shape priorities for action.

There is recognition that progress has been made since 1995. Across Africa, legal and policy reforms have strengthened gender equality, including the adoption of the Maputo Protocol in 2003, which has been ratified by 42 African Union Member States, and the inclusion of gender equality provisions in many national constitutions.

However, engagement across the region highlights that these gains have not fully translated into lived equality. **Women and girls, particularly young women, continue to face multiple and intersecting forms of discrimination shaped by social norms, economic inequality, and unequal access to power and resources.**

The Beijing+30 review in Africa is also taking place in a complex context marked by conflict, climate change, economic pressures, shrinking civic space, and technology related risks, all of which affect the implementation of gender equality commitments.

A key priority emerging from regional engagement is the need for meaningful youth inclusion. While youth have been part of the review process, there is a strong call for their active participation in decision making, implementation, and accountability processes.

Engagement around Beijing+30 in Africa highlights the need for stronger accountability, sustained financing, inclusive participation, and practical action to ensure that commitments result in real improvements in the lives of women, girls, and youth across the continent. For more information click the following: Africa Youth Position Statement on Beijing +30 Review Consultation. https://www.femnet.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/Africa-Youth-Position-Statement_WEB.pdf

Key takeaway

Beijing+30 is best understood as a global review and acceleration moment. **It looks back to the commitments made in 1995, examines what has and has not changed over thirty years, and identifies the actions needed now to secure faster and more meaningful progress.**

It highlights that while progress has been made globally, it has been uneven and context-specific. In regions such as Africa, engagement around Beijing+30 shows both important legal and policy advances and the continued reality of inequality shaped by social norms, economic conditions, and structural barriers. It also underscores the importance of inclusive participation, particularly the meaningful involvement of youth and civil society in shaping and driving change.

Access the dashboard via the link below to explore Member State announcements, highlighting the priority areas they have selected and the actions they have committed to in order to drive change for women and girls: https://beijing30.unwomen.org/directory/.

Exercise:

What key gaps or challenges identified in the Beijing+30 review are most visible in your context?

Chapter 3
Introducing the GEF (Born out of Beijing 25+) and speaking on the build-up negotiations, launch of GEF and lead countries[Based on refs 3.1-3.5]

Why the Forum Was Needed

More than 25 years after the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, progress has been too slow and uneven.

Global commitments have not been matched with action, financing, or implementation.

Over **2.1 billion** women and girls are projected to live in countries that will not meet key gender equality targets by 2030.

No country is on track to achieve all targets.

This highlights the **urgent need** to move from rhetoric to action.

The Forum responded by building and mobilizing a powerful global movement that drives increased financing, stronger laws and policies, expanded programmes and services, and measurable commitments across key priority areas to accelerate tangible progress on gender equality during the UN Decade of Action (2020-2030).

Generation Equality Forum Overview

The Generation Equality Forum is a global platform launched in 2021 to accelerate progress on gender equality through concrete, ambitious, and measurable action.

Convened by UN Women and co-chaired by the governments of France and Mexico, the Forum brought together governments, civil society, youth, the private sector, international organizations, and others. Held in Mexico City (March 2021) and Paris (June-July 2021), it marked the beginning of a five-year action journey (2021–2026) aimed at achieving irreversible progress toward gender equality.

What Makes the Forum Different?

The Forum focuses on actual action, accountability, and results. It generated:

- **Over USD 40 billion in financial commitments**
- **Multiple policy and program commitments**
- **A shared global agenda to accelerate gender equality**

It also strengthened a global coalition of activists, feminists, youth, and allies, ensuring gender equality remains central to global priorities, including post-COVID recovery.

How the Forum Drives Action

The Forum's ambitions are carried forward through:

- **A Global Acceleration Plan made up of a set of Action Coalitions**
- **A Compact on Women, Peace and Security and Humanitarian Action**

The Action Coalitions focus on six critical areas:

Gender-Based Violence

Economic Justice and Rights

Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR)

Gender-Based Violence

Economic Justice and Rights

Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR)

These coalitions are global, multi-stakeholder partnerships that catalyse collective action, spark conversations across generations and communities, drive increased public and private investment, and deliver tangible and needle-shifting results.

How the Forum Works: Leadership and Commitment

The Generation Equality Forum is built on a shared, multi-stakeholder leadership approach, **where diverse actors work together to drive change and ensure that commitments lead to real results.** Governments play a central role by shaping laws and policies, investing in systems and services, and ensuring accountability.

Leadership is also shared with women's and feminist organizations; academia or research associations; civil society and community-based organizations; youth-led organizations; private sector and philanthropic actors; international and regional organizations. Together, these stakeholders form the backbone of the Action Coalitions, working collaboratively to drive progress across priority areas.

The Action Coalitions bring these actors together to catalyse collective action, spark conversations across generations and communities, and drive increased public and private investment. Their work is guided by Action Coalition blueprints, which outline a clear vision for success, priority actions, strategies, and measurable targets.

These blueprints are grounded in:
- **Feminist leadership**
- **Transformative change**
- **An intersectional approach, recognizing that women and girls experience multiple and overlapping forms of inequality**

Together, they form the Global Acceleration Plan for gender equality, helping to advance the Sustainable Development Goals and the implementation of the Beijing Platform for Action.

A key driver of this work is the role of commitment makers, who turn plans into action.
Anyone can be a commitment maker, and they contribute by:
- **Providing resources, funding, and financial investments (financial commitments)**
- **Leading advocacy efforts (advocacy commitments)**
- **Supporting policy and legal reforms (policy commitments)**
- **Implementing programmes and initiatives (programmatic commitments)**

Many commitments are collective and large-scale, such as global alliances and funds that expand care systems, improve access to services, support climate solutions, and strengthen feminist movements. All commitments are expected to be bold, measurable, collaborative, and grounded in feminist and intersectional principles.

BWC is one of the commitment makers under the category of youth-led organizations. There are many more commitment makers, a full list of which can be found through the following link: https://forum.generationequality.org/sites/default/files/2021-09/GEF Commitment Makers.pdf

Key Takeaway

The Genenration Equality Forum represents a shift from commitments to action. Its success depends on:

Ultimately, **the Forum is about ensuring that gender equality is not just promised – but delivered,** creating lasting change for women and girls in all their diversity. Also, the Generation Equality Forum, born out of the Beijing+25 review of progress since the 1995 Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, serves as a critical bridge between past commitments and ongoing action. Now in the Beijing+30 period, the Forum continues to play a pivotal role in shifting the focus from promises to implementation – driving accountability, mobilizing resources, and ensuring that gender equality commitments translate into real, measurable change.

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:

- What is the purpose of Beijing+30, and why is it important to review progress on gender equality 30 years after the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action?
- Based on the Beijing+30 review, what are the key gaps between commitments and implementation, and what needs to change to accelerate progress in your context?

Chapter 4
Action Coalition on Feminist Movements and Leadership [Based on ref 4.1]

Gender Equality Forum Overview

The Action Coalition on Feminist Movements and Leadership is part of a global effort to move from words to real, funded, and transformative action on gender equality. It brings together governments, civil society, youth, and other stakeholders to strengthen feminist movements and leadership in practical and measurable ways.

At its heart, the coalition envisions a future where by 2026 feminist leaders and organizations are supported, sustainable, and able to work without fear, and where they can actively advance gender equality, peace, and human rights for all.

As you go through this section, think about how these goals connect to your own context and what role you can play in contributing to this collective effort.

Why This Work Matters

Before understanding how the coalition works, it is important to understand why it exists. Despite progress, significant gaps remain:

- **Women's representation in national parliaments has increased, but progress is still slow, and equality is far from being achieved**

- **Very little funding reaches women's and feminist organizations**

- **Women are present in the workforce but are underrepresented in decision-making positions**

These challenges show that change is not only about participation – it is about power, resources, and leadership.

The coalition responds to these gaps by focusing on strengthening feminist movements so they can drive lasting and meaningful change.

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

For feminist movements and leaders to thrive, certain conditions must be strengthened. The coalition focuses on key areas that enable action: laws and policies; financing (funding); social norms; education and capacity building; and data and accountability

- **Laws and policies** help remove barriers and create equal opportunities. When they are inclusive and gender-transformative, they support meaningful participation in leadership and decision-making.

- **Financing is essential.** The coalition emphasizes increasing funding for feminist movements, especially those led by diverse groups, so they can sustain and grow their work.

- **Social norms shape how leadership is understood.** Addressing harmful norms helps open space for women, girls, and non-binary people to participate fully.

- **Education and capacity building** strengthen leadership by equipping individuals – especially young feminists – with the skills and confidence to lead.

- **Data and accountability** ensure that progress is tracked and that commitments lead to real outcomes, not just intentions.

These elements work together to create an environment where feminist movements can operate effectively and safely.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Funding and Supporting Feminist Movements

The goal is to significantly increase funding for women-led and feminist organizations so they can sustain their work and expand their impact.

2. Protecting Civic Space

This includes promoting and protecting safe spaces – both offline and online – where feminist activists can organize and mobilize without fear, and where barriers to action are removed.

3. Advancing Leadership and Decision-Making

The coalition works to increase the participation and leadership of women, girls, and non-binary people across all sectors, including government, civil society, and the private sector.

4. Strengthening Young Feminist Leaders

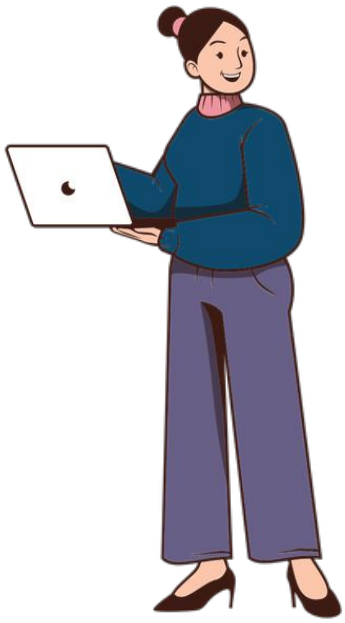
A strong focus is placed on adolescent girls and young feminists by providing them with resources, support, and safe spaces to participate in decision-making processes.

Together, these priority areas address the key challenges identified and aim to create lasting, systemic change.

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

In the context of the Action Coalition on Feminist Movements and Leadership, commitment makers are not only contributors but also drivers of systemic change.
Their actions help to:

- **Strengthen and sustain feminist movements and organizations**
- **Protect activists and expand civic space for organizing and mobilization**
- **Increase meaningful participation and leadership of women, girls, and nonbinary people**
- **Support and empower adolescent girls and young feminist leaders**



Key Takeaway

To understand the Action Coalition on Feminist Movements and Leadership, it is important to see how everything connects:

- **The coalition responds to real gaps in funding, leadership, and participation**
- **It focuses on clear priority actions that address these challenges**
- **It relies on shared leadership across multiple stakeholders**
- **It turns vision into action through strong, measurable commitments**

Together, these elements support a future where feminist movements are resilient, inclusive, and fully supported, and where leaders can advance gender equality, peace, and human rights without fear.

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:
- Which of the four priority areas of action is most relevant in your context?
- What kind of commitment could you or your organization make to support this work?

Chapter 5
Action Coalition on Gender Based Violence

Based on ref 5.1

This chapter introduces the Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence and helps you understand its purpose, focus, and approach. The coalition is part of a global effort to move from commitments to real, coordinated, and scaled-up action to end gender-based violence (GBV) against women and girls in all their diversity. It brings together governments, civil society, the private sector, and other stakeholders to address what has been identified as a global emergency.

At its core, the coalition **envisions a world where violence is prevented, survivors are supported, and systems are strengthened to ensure accountability and justice.** It also emphasizes that women's rights organizations must be recognized, supported, and well-resourced, and that efforts must be intersectional and evidence-driven.

As you engage with this section, consider how gender-based violence shows up in your context and what actions are needed to address it.

Why This Work Matters

Gender-based violence remains one of the most widespread and persistent violations of human rights.

Key realities include:

- Nearly **1 in 3** women globally have experienced physical or sexual violence
- Many adolescent girls experience violence **early in life**
- **Violence is often underreported**, with many survivors not seeking help
- Harmful **social norms and unequal power** relations continue to drive violence
- Progress is slowed by limited political will and **backlash against women's rights**
- Crises such as **COVID-19** have increased levels of violence

These challenges show that GBV is not only an individual issue – it is systemic, rooted in inequality, social norms, and power imbalances.

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

To effectively prevent and respond to gender-based violence, the coalition focuses on strengthening key enabling areas: laws and policies; financing (funding); social norms; education and capacity building; data and accountability; and service delivery

- **Laws and policies** are critical for prohibiting all forms of GBV and ensuring justice for survivors. Strengthening and implementing these frameworks is a key priority.
- **Financing** ensures that prevention efforts, survivor services, and women's rights organizations are properly supported and sustained.
- **Social norms must be addressed** to challenge the attitudes and beliefs that normalize or tolerate violence.
- **Education and capacity building** support prevention and strengthen the ability of institutions and communities to respond effectively.
- **Data and accountability** systems help track progress, improve responses, and ensure that commitments lead to measurable outcomes.
- **Service delivery** ensures that survivors have access to comprehensive, accessible, and quality support, including health, justice, and social services.

Together, these elements create a coordinated system for both preventing violence and supporting survivors.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Strengthening Laws, Policies, and Accountability
The coalition supports countries and institutions to adopt and implement evidence-driven laws, policies, and action plans to end GBV. This includes increasing the number of countries with laws that prohibit all forms of violence and addressing harmful practices such as child marriage and FGM.

2. Scaling Up Prevention Efforts
A strong focus is placed on evidence-based prevention strategies that address the root causes of violence, including harmful social norms and unequal power relations. This includes increasing investment in prevention and promoting gender-equitable beliefs.

3. Expanding Survivor-Centred Services
The coalition works to ensure that survivors have access to comprehensive, accessible, and quality services, including police, justice, health, and social support. Strengthening institutional capacity is key to this effort.

4. Increasing Funding and Support for Women's Rights Organizations
Women's rights organizations play a central role in addressing GBV. The coalition emphasizes increasing flexible and quality funding to support their work and strengthen their leadership and accountability.

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

In the context of the Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence, commitment makers play a critical role in preventing and responding to violence, strengthening protection systems, and ensuring accountability for survivors.

Their actions help to:

- **Strengthen laws, policies, and accountability systems**
- **Scale up prevention strategies and shift harmful social norms**
- **Expand access to quality, survivor-centred services**
- **Increase funding and support for women's rights organizations**

Key Takeaway

To understand the Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence, it is important to see how its elements work together:

- **The coalition responds to a global crisis of violence and inequality**
- **It focuses on prevention, protection, services, and funding**
- **It relies on shared leadership across sectors**
- **It drives progress through strong, measurable commitments**

Together, these efforts aim to create a world where gender-based violence is prevented, survivors are supported, and systems are accountable

Take a moment to reflect:

- What are the main drivers of gender-based violence in your context?
- Which of the four priority areas of action requires the most attention in your work or at BWC as a commitment maker?
- What action or commitment could you or BWC support to help address GBV?

Chapter 6
Action Coalition on Economic Justice and Rights[Based on ref 6.1]

The Action Coalition on Economic Justice and Rights is part of a global effort to ensure that women and girls, in all their diversity, have equal access to economic opportunities, resources, and decision-making. It focuses on transforming economic systems so that they are fair, inclusive, and responsive to gender inequalities.

At its core, the coalition envisions a future where economic justice is guaranteed, where systems are gender-responsive, and where women's voices and leadership are fully recognized and valued. This includes ensuring fair labour markets, equitable access to resources, and resilience to economic shocks such as the COVID-19 pandemic.

As you engage with this section, reflect on how economic inequality affects women and girls in your context and what changes are needed to address it.

Why This Work Matters

Despite progress, economic inequality remains deeply rooted and widespread.
Key realities include:

Women spend three times more time than men on unpaid care and domestic work

The majority of women lack access to adequate social protection systems

740+M

Millions of women work in the informal sector, often in insecure and low-paying jobs

Young women are significantly more likely to be excluded from education and employment

The gender gap in labour force participation has remained largely unchanged for decades

Economic shocks, such as COVID-19, are pushing more women into poverty

These challenges show that economic inequality is not accidental – it is shaped by systems, structures, and social norms that disadvantage women and girls.

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

To advance economic justice, the coalition focuses on strengthening key enabling areas: laws and policies; financing; social norms; education and capacity building; data and accountability; service delivery.

- **Laws and policies are essential for creating fair labour markets, protecting rights, and ensuring equal access to opportunities and resources.**
- **Financing supports investments in care systems, social protection, and economic opportunities for women and girls.**
- **Social norms influence how work, leadership, and economic participation are valued. Addressing these norms is key to reducing inequality.**
- **Education and capacity building equip women and girls with the skills needed to participate in and benefit from economic systems.**
- **Data and accountability ensure that inequalities are measured and addressed through evidence-based decision-making.**
- **Service delivery, including access to financial services and social protection, ensures that economic opportunities are accessible in practice.**

Together, these elements support the transformation of economic systems to be more inclusive and equitable.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Transforming the Care Economy
The coalition aims to recognize, reduce, and redistribute unpaid care work, while ensuring that care work is valued and supported.
This includes:

- **Investing in quality care services**
- **Creating up to 80 million decent care jobs**
- **Ensuring labour rights for care workers**

This area addresses one of the biggest barriers to women's economic participation.

2. Expanding Decent Work and Employment
The coalition works to create an enabling environment for women to access decent work in both formal and informal economies.
This includes:

- **Strengthening labour protections**
- **Reducing the number of women living in poverty**
- **Supporting women's participation in economic activities**

3. Increasing Access to and Control Over Productive Resources
A key focus is ensuring that women have greater access to and control over resources, including:

- **Land and property**
- **Financial products and services**
- **Business ownership opportunities**

This supports women's economic independence and long-term security.

4. Promoting Gender-Transformative Economies
The coalition promotes economic systems that are inclusive and responsive to gender inequality, including:

- **Gender-responsive macroeconomic policies**
- **Budget reforms and stimulus packages**
- **Expanded social protection systems**

These efforts aim to significantly reduce poverty among women and girls.

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

A key way the coalition drives progress is through commitments – clear and measurable actions taken by stakeholders.

In the context of the Action Coalition on Economic Justice and Rights, commitment makers play a key role in advancing economic equality by transforming systems, expanding opportunities, and addressing structural barriers.
Their actions help to:

- **Transform the care economy and reduce unpaid care burdens**
- **Expand access to decent work and economic opportunities**
- **Increase women's control over productive resources**
- **Promote gender-responsive economic systems and policies**

Through these commitments, stakeholders contribute to real and lasting economic change.

Key Takeaway

To understand the Action Coalition on Economic Justice and Rights, it is important to see how its elements connect:

- **The coalition addresses deep structural economic inequalities**
- **It focuses on care, work, resources, and economic systems**
- **It relies on shared leadership across sectors**
- **It drives progress through strong, measurable commitments**

Together, these efforts aim to create economies where women and girls can fully participate, benefit, and lead, and where economic systems are fair, inclusive, and resilient.

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:

- What are the biggest economic barriers facing women and girls in your context?
- Which of the four priority areas is most urgent in your work or at BWC?
- What action or commitment could you or BWC support to advance economic justice?

Chapter 7
Action Coalition on Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health Rights

Based on ref 7.1

At its core, the Action Coalition on Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) focuses on a fundamental principle: every woman and girl has the right to make decisions about her own body, free from coercion, violence, and discrimination.

The coalition envisions a world where women and girls in all their diversity are empowered to exercise their sexual and reproductive health and rights, with access to information, education, and services that are available, accessible, acceptable, and of high quality. It also emphasizes strengthening feminist organizations and ensuring that governments actively promote and invest in SRHR as part of broader health systems.

As you engage with this section, consider how bodily autonomy is experienced in your context and what barriers prevent people from fully exercising these rights

Why This Work Matters

Bodily autonomy and SRHR are essential for dignity, health, and equality, yet many women and girls are still unable to make decisions about their own bodies.

Key realities include:

- **45% of women and girls aged 15-49 who are married or in unions cannot make their own decisions about healthcare, contraception, or sexual relations**
- **A significant number of maternal deaths occur in fragile and conflict settings, where access to services is limited**
- **Adolescents from poorer households are far more likely to experience early pregnancy**
- **Inequalities in access to SRHR services are shaped by poverty, crisis, and social norms**

These challenges highlight that bodily autonomy is not only a personal issue – it is shaped by laws, systems, and social norms that must be transformed.

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

To advance bodily autonomy and SRHR, the coalition focuses on key enabling areas: laws and policies; service delivery; social norms; education and capacity building; financing; data and accountability; as well as participation and accountability mechanisms.

- **Laws and policies** are critical for protecting rights, removing restrictive barriers, and ensuring access to services such as contraception and safe abortion.
- **Service delivery** ensures that SRHR services are available and of high quality.
- **Social norms influence attitudes toward** sexuality, gender roles, and decision-making. Transforming these norms is essential for real change.
- **Education and capacity building,** especially through comprehensive sexuality education, empower individuals with knowledge about their rights and health.
- **Financing** supports the expansion and sustainability of SRHR services.
- **Data and accountability** help track progress and ensure commitments are implemented.
- **Participation and accountability** mechanisms ensure that women, girls, and feminist organizations are actively involved in shaping decisions that affect them.

Together, these elements create an environment where bodily autonomy can be realized in practice.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Expanding Comprehensive Sexuality Education
The coalition aims to increase access to comprehensive sexuality education both in and out of school.This includes:
- **Reaching 50 million more children, adolescents, and youth by 2026**
- **Providing accurate, age-appropriate information on health, rights, and relationships**

This empowers young people to make informed decisions about their bodies and lives.

2. Increasing Access to Contraception and Safe Abortion Services
A major priority is ensuring that SRHR services are: available, accessible, acceptable, and of high quality. This includes:
- **Expanding access to contraception for 50 million more women and girls**
- **Removing restrictive laws and policies**
- **Ensuring that more women live in contexts where safe and legal abortion is accessible**

3. Strengthening Decision-Making and Bodily Autonomy
The coalition works to empower women and girls to make autonomous decisions about their bodies, sexuality, and reproduction. This includes:

- **Reaching 260 million more women and girls with knowledge and support**
- **Promoting legal and policy reforms in at least 20 countries**
- **Addressing harmful gender norms**

4. Strengthening Feminist Organizations and Movements
The coalition recognizes the importance of women's and feminist organizations in driving change. This includes:
- **Increasing support and funding for these organizations**
- **Strengthening participation and accountability**
- **Supporting networks, movements, and human rights defenders**

These actors play a critical role in advancing and protecting SRHR.

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

In the context of the Action Coalition on Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights, commitment makers play a vital role in promoting bodily autonomy, expanding access to services, and protecting the rights of women and girls.
Their actions support:

- **The expansion of comprehensive sexuality education**
- **Access to high-quality SRHR services**
- **The protection and promotion of bodily autonomy**
* **The strengthening of feminist organizations and movements**

Through these commitments, stakeholders contribute to meaningful and lasting improvements in SRHR.

Key Takeaway

To understand this Action Coalition, it is important to see how its elements connect:

- **It focuses on bodily autonomy as a fundamental human right**
- **It addresses barriers in education, services, laws, and social norms**
- **It prioritizes young people, women, and marginalized groups**
- **It relies on collective leadership and accountability**
* **It drives progress through clear, measurable commitments**

Together, these efforts aim to create a world where all women and girls can make informed decisions about their bodies and lives, and where their rights are respected, protected, and fulfilled.

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:
- What barriers limit bodily autonomy in your context?
- Which of the four priority areas needs the most attention where you work?
- What action or commitment could you support to advance SRHR?

Chapter 8
Action Coalition on Feminist Action for Climate Justice Based on ref 8.1

At its core, the Action Coalition on Feminist Action for Climate Justice recognizes that climate change is not gender-neutral. It affects women and girls differently, often more severely, while at the same time limiting their participation in decision-making and access to resources.

The coalition envisions a world where **women and girls in all their diversity lead and shape climate action,** where climate solutions are inclusive and regenerative, and where the voices of grassroots, Indigenous, and frontline communities are protected and amplified. It also emphasizes that climate justice must be approached through a human rights-based, intersectional lens, linking environmental sustainability with gender equality.

As you engage with this section, think about how climate change impacts your community and

Why This Work Matters

Climate change is a global crisis, but its impacts are uneven, and women and girls often face greater barriers.
Key realities include:

- **Only 3% of philanthropic environmental funding supports women's and girls' environmental activism**
- **Women and girls are underrepresented in climate leadership and decision-making at all levels**
- **Less than a third of students in fields linked to green jobs are women and girls**
- **Climate responses often fail to address women's lived realities, including health, economic vulnerability, and unpaid care work**
- **Despite their role in agriculture, women hold less than 15% of land globally**

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

To advance feminist climate justice, the coalition focuses on key enabling areas: financing; laws and policies; service delivery; social norms; education and capacity building; and data and accountability.

- **Financing is central to ensuring that resources reach women and girls, especially at grassroots levels.**
- **Laws and policies help create an enabling environment for women's leadership, land rights, and climate justice.**
- **Service delivery supports access to climate solutions, technologies, and resilience-building initiatives.**
- **Social norms influence who participates in climate decision-making and whose knowledge is valued.**
- **Education and capacity building equip women and girls with the skills and knowledge needed to lead in climate sectors.**
- **Data and accountability ensure that gender-responsive climate action is tracked and informed by evidence.**

Together, these elements support a shift toward a more inclusive, equitable, and sustainable climate response.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Increasing Access to Climate Finance for Women and Girls

The coalition aims to increase direct access to financing for gender-just climate solutions. This includes:

- **Increasing the proportion of global climate finance directed toward gender-responsive initiatives**
- **Prioritizing grassroots and rural women and girls**
- **Strengthening investments in community-based climate solutions**

2. Enabling Women and Girls to Lead a Just Green Transition

A key priority is increasing women's participation in leadership and decision-making in climate and environmental sectors. This includes:

- **Expanding leadership roles for women and girls**
- **Supporting participation in environmental governance**
- **Promoting inclusive, circular, and regenerative green economies**

3. Building Resilience to Climate Impacts

The coalition works to strengthen the ability of women and girls to respond to and recover from climate-related risks. This includes:

- **Supporting community-based and cooperative approaches**
- **Enhancing resilience to disasters, loss, and damage**
- **Promoting land rights and tenure security**

4. Strengthening Gender-Responsive Climate Data

The coalition emphasizes the importance of data on the gender-environment nexus. This includes:

- **Increasing the production and use of gender-environment statistics**
- **Supporting at least 20 countries to integrate this data into policy**
- **Creating enabling environments for evidence-based decision-making**

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

In the context of the Action Coalition on Feminist Action for Climate Justice, commitment makers play an important role in driving gender-responsive climate action, strengthening resilience, and supporting inclusive environmental leadership.
Their actions support:

- **Increased financing for gender-just climate solutions**
- **Women's leadership in climate governance**
- **Greater resilience to climate impacts**
- **Improved use of gender-responsive climate data**

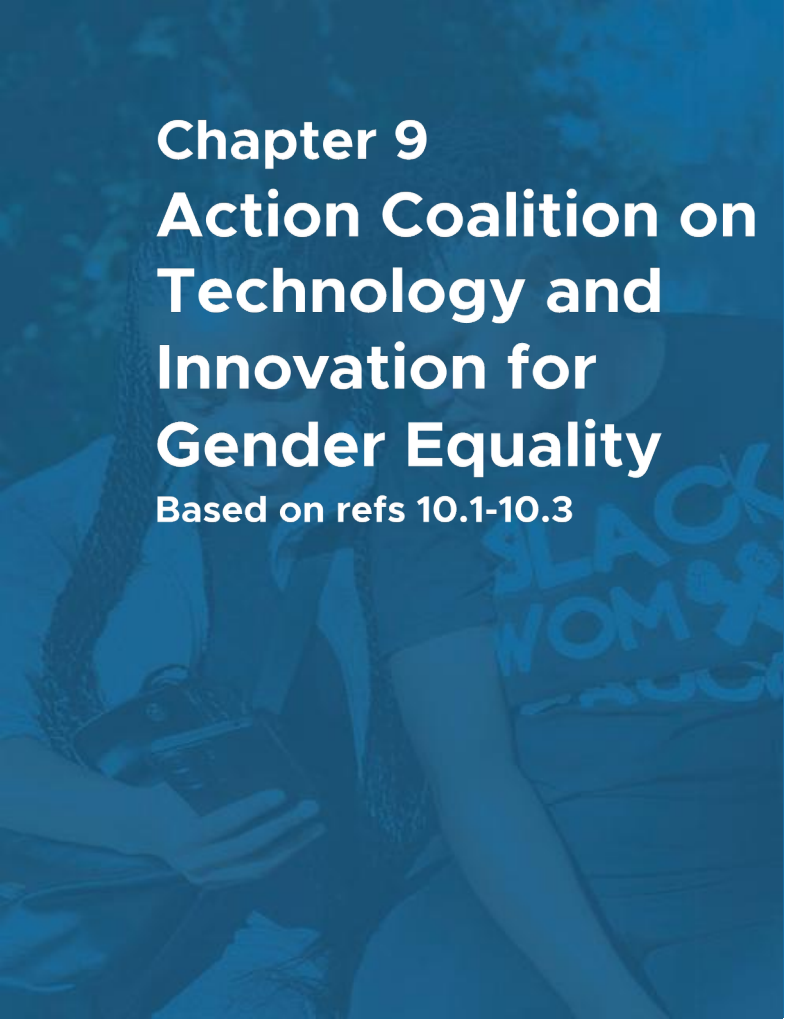
Through these commitments, stakeholders contribute to building climate solutions that are both just and sustainable.

Key Takeaway

To understand this Action Coalition, it is important to see how its elements connect:

- **It links climate justice with gender equality**
- **It focuses on financing, leadership, resilience, and data**
- **It prioritizes grassroots, Indigenous, and frontline communities**
- **It promotes inclusive and regenerative climate solutions**
- **It relies on collective leadership and accountability**

Together, these efforts aim to create a future where women and girls are not only affected by climate change but are leading the solutions.



Chapter 9
Action Coalition on Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality

Based on refs 10.1-10.3

Technology and innovation shape how we live, learn, work, and connect. However, not everyone benefits equally. **Women and girls often face barriers in accessing digital tools, participating in innovation spaces, and shaping the technologies that influence their lives.**

This Action Coalition on Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality envisions a world where women and girls in all their diversity can safely access, use, lead, and design technology and innovation – with freedom, confidence, and opportunity. It also calls for shared responsibility, especially from governments and corporations, to ensure that digital spaces are inclusive, accountable, and transformative.

As you engage with this section, consider how technology shows up in your own life and whose voices are included in creating it.

Why This Work Matters

Despite rapid technological advancement, significant gender gaps remain.
Key realities include:

- **Only 0.5% of girls (compared to 5% of boys) aspire to become ICT professionals**
- **Women are underrepresented in STEM fields and innovation spaces**
- **Around 300 million fewer women than men access mobile internet**
- **Women are 20% less likely to own a smartphone in many low- and middle-income countries**
- **Many women have less autonomy and agency over accessing digital technologies**
- **A high prevalence of online gender-based violence (GBV) affects women globally**

These challenges highlight a persistent gender digital divide, limiting opportunities for women and girls to fully participate in digital economies and societies.

What Makes the Work Possible? (Enabling Frameworks)

To address these challenges, the coalition focuses on key enabling areas: laws and policies; social norms; financing; service delivery; and data and accountability.

- **Laws and policies create protections and promote gender equality in digital spaces.**
- **Social norms influence participation by addressing stereotypes and biases in technology fields.**
- **Financing supports innovation, skills development, and inclusive digital solutions.**
- **Service delivery ensures access to digital tools, services, and learning platforms.**
- **Data and accountability help track progress and ensure inclusive innovation ecosystems.**

Together, these elements create the conditions for equitable participation and leadership in technology and innovation.

What Does the Coalition Focus On? (Priority Actions)

The coalition focuses on four key areas of action:

1. Bridging the Gender Digital Divide

The coalition aims to reduce the gender gap in digital access and competences. This includes:

- **Expanding access to digital technologies**
- **Promoting universal digital literacy**
- **Addressing barriers across different generations**
- **Challenging stereotypes that limit girls' participation**

2. Investing in Feminist Technology and Innovation

The coalition promotes increased investment in feminist technology and innovation. This includes:

- **Increasing investments by 50% to support women innovators**
- **Supporting solutions that respond to women and girls' needs**
- **Embedding gender perspectives in technology development**
- **Using data and accountability frameworks to guide innovation**

3. Building Inclusive and Transformative Innovation Ecosystems

A key priority is to ensure that innovation ecosystems are inclusive and representative. This includes:

- **Doubling the proportion of women working in technology and innovation**
- **Creating networks and opportunities within digital and innovation hubs**
- **Promoting women's leadership and participation**
- **Measuring inclusion and diversity in digital economies**

4. Preventing and Eliminating Online Gender-Based Violence

The coalition addresses online and tech-facilitated GBV and discrimination. This includes:

- **Strengthening policies and legislation**
- **Developing tools to prevent, detect, and respond to online harm**
- **Promoting cultural and social change in digital spaces**
- **Ensuring accountability among governments and tech companies**

Commitment Making in the Action Coalition

In the context of the Action Coalition on Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality, commitment makers play a crucial role in advancing digital inclusion, fostering innovation, and ensuring safe and equitable digital environments.
Their actions support:

- **Closing the gender digital divide**
- **Increasing women's leadership in innovation**
- **Expanding investment in feminist technology**
- **Creating safer digital environments free from violence and discrimination**

Through these commitments, stakeholders help build a digital future that is inclusive, safe, and empowering.

Key Takeaway

To understand this Action Coalition, it is important to see how its elements connect:

- **It addresses the gender digital divide**
- **It promotes access, skills, and leadership in technology**
- **It invests in feminist innovation**
- **It works to eliminate online violence and discrimination**
- **It relies on shared responsibility across sectors**

Together, these efforts aim to ensure that women and girls are not only users of technology but leaders and creators shaping the digital world.

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:

- Who has access to technology in your community – and who does not?
- What barriers do women and girls face in digital spaces?
- How can technology be used to advance gender equality in your context or at BWC?

Chapter 10
Compact on Women, Peace & Security and Humanitarian Action and GEF Accountability Framework

Based on refs 10.1-10.3

Understanding the Compact on Women, Peace and Security and Humanitarian Action and the Accountability Framework

The Compact on Women, Peace and Security and Humanitarian Action (WPS-HA Compact) is a key outcome of the Generation Equality Forum. It is a multi-stakeholder initiative that brings together Member States, United Nations entities, regional organisations, civil society, and the private sector to accelerate the implementation of existing commitments on women, peace and security and humanitarian action.

The Compact is grounded in established global frameworks, including the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action (1995) and UN Security Council Resolution 1325 (2000). It does not introduce new commitments, but focuses on ensuring that existing ones are implemented in a coordinated and effective way, particularly in conflict and crisis settings where women and girls remain underrepresented.

The Compact promotes a coordinated and holistic approach, strengthening collaboration across existing mechanisms and actors.

It emphasizes the importance of women's full, equal, and meaningful participation and leadership, as well as the need to address structural barriers that prevent women and girls from influencing peace and humanitarian processes.

A central feature of the Compact is its accountability framework, which establishes a voluntary monitoring and accountability process. This process builds, where possible, on existing reporting systems to track progress on commitments, strengthen coordination, and promote increased financing and visibility for the Women, Peace and Security and Humanitarian Action agenda.

The Compact aims to support transformative and measurable progress in areas such as women's participation in peace processes, leadership across peace and humanitarian sectors, protection of women's human rights, and women's access to resources and services in conflict and crisis contexts.

Latest Key Findings on the Compact and the Action Coalitions

The findings in the 2024 Generation Equality Accountability Report show that both the Action Coalitions and the WPS-HA Compact are delivering measurable progress across multiple areas of gender equality, while also highlighting gaps that require continued attention. Across all Action Coalitions and the WPS-HA Compact, implementation is advancing steadily. 16% of commitments have been completed and 75% are in progress, with 91% of ongoing commitments on track. Financial commitments have reached $50.3 billion, with $40.4 billion secured and more than $21 billion already spent.

Table 10.1 below highlights key results from the WPS-HA Compact, showing its reach, financing, and contribution to policy and inclusion outcomes.

Area	Key Findings (2024)
Reach and Impact	At least **24.8 million** women and girls reached through Compact actions.
Financing	At least **$1.5 billion** spent to support implementation.
Policy Change	**53%** of signatories adopted new laws, policies, or strategies.
Youth Inclusion	**91%** of signatories integrated youth and intergenerational approaches.

Table 10.2 below presents a snapshot of progress across each Action Coalition, including key areas of action, financial commitments, and implementation outcomes.

Action Coalition	Key Findings (2024)
Feminist Movements and Leadership	**166** commitments reported. **10%** completed, **82%** in progress, and **88%** on track. Around **$1.7 billion** pledged, supporting feminist movements and leadership development.
Gender-Based Violence	**$8.5 billion** secured out of **$10.3 billion** pledged. Delivered **1,184** policies, **1,050 programmes**, and **3,620** advocacy initiatives. Progress noted in prevention and response, though funding gaps remain for civil society and youth-led organisations.
Economic Justice and Rights	Highest financial commitments with **$30.9 billion** pledged, **$27.4 billion** secured, and **$12.4 billion** spent. Achieved **303** policies, **899** programmes, and **487** advocacy initiatives focused on care systems and economic inclusion.

Action Coalition	Key Findings (2024)
Bodily Autonomy and SRHR	**172** Commitment Makers reported on **71%** of commitments. Delivered **172** policies, **769** programmes, and **483** advocacy initiatives. Financials include **$6.7 billion** pledged, **$3.3 billion** secured, and **$2.3 billion** spent.
Feminist Action for Climate Justice	**120** commitments reported. Achieved **65** policies, **378** programmes, and **224** advocacy initiatives. Around **$560 million** pledged, focusing on climate justice and green transitions.
Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality	**126** commitments focused on closing the digital gender gap. **$211 million** pledged, **$149 million** secured, and **$133 million** spent. Actions include digital inclusion and addressing online violence.

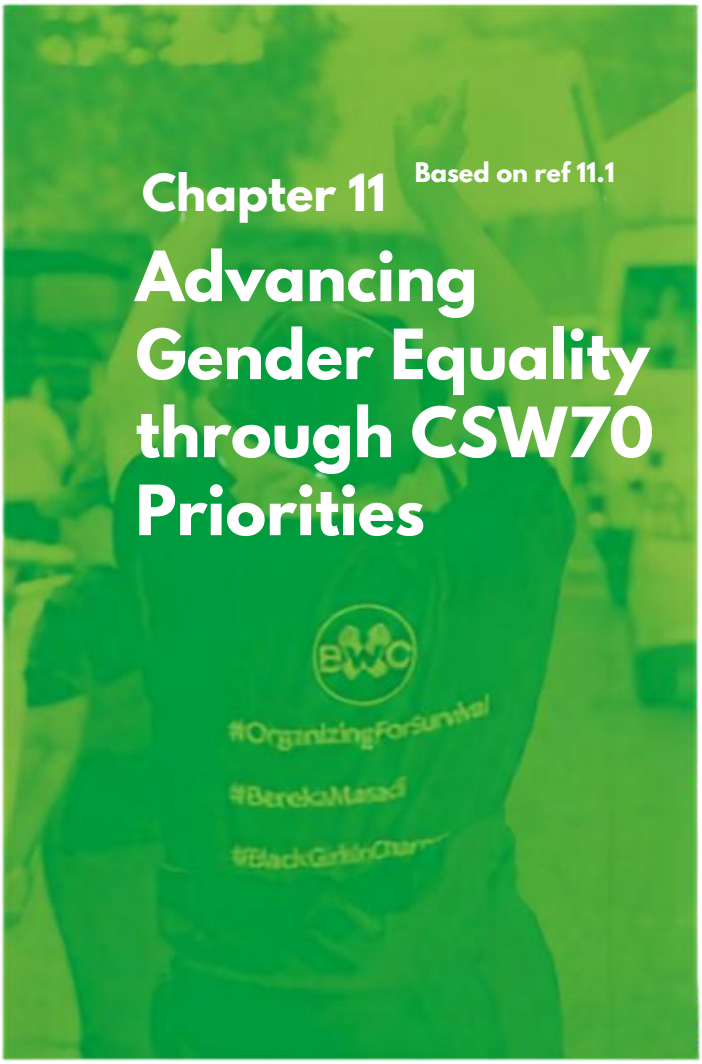
Key Takeaway

The Compact and the Action Coalitions demonstrate that gender equality commitments can lead to measurable and large-scale results when supported by strong partnerships, financing, and accountability systems. At the same time, the findings highlight that **progress remains uneven, and sustained effort is needed to strengthen implementation, ensure inclusion, and address funding gaps, particularly for youth-led and grassroots organisations.**

Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:

- *What do the latest findings reveal about the importance of accountability and partnerships in advancing gender equality?*
- *Based on these findings, what actions can you or your organisation take to strengthen implementation and impact within your context?*



Based on ref 11.1

Chapter 11
Advancing Gender Equality through CSW70 Priorities

As we come to the final part of this training, it becomes important to ask a deeper question: **What does all of this mean in practice?**

The CSW70 priorities help answer this question by placing strong emphasis on women's and girls' access to justice. They highlight that, **despite existing commitments, systemic failings continue to deny rights and limit the ability of justice systems to deliver equitable and lasting outcomes.**

In this context, justice is understood broadly. It includes not only legal processes, but also whether women and girls are able to access opportunities, participate in decision-making, and live free from violence and discrimination across social, economic, political, cultural, and digital spheres.

From Commitments to Lived Realities

A key message from the CSW70 priorities is that commitments must translate into real improvements in people's lives. While global frameworks have established important legal and policy standards, many women and girls still experience barriers that prevent them from accessing justice.

These barriers are described as structural, meaning they are embedded in systems and institutions. They affect areas such as economic participation, political inclusion, and access to services. The priorities therefore call for dismantling these barriers and ensuring that justice mechanisms are accessible, inclusive, and effective in practice.

This reinforces what has been discussed in earlier chapters, particularly the need to move from commitments to implementation, accountability, and impact.

Rethinking Justice

The CSW70 priorities also expand the understanding of justice. They highlight the importance of transitional justice, which includes truth-seeking, prosecutions, reparations, and institutional reforms aimed at preventing future harm.

Importantly, this approach goes beyond responding to individual cases. It focuses on addressing root causes of vlence, systemic discrimination, and long-standing inequalities, with the goal of achieving lasting social and institutional change.

This perspective aligns with the emphasis in earlier frameworks on accountability and structural transformation, particularly in contexts affected by conflict, inequality, and exclusion.

Connecting Across Systems

The CSW70 priorities make it clear that gender equality must be addressed across multiple, interconnected areas of justice:

- **Social justice, which recognises women and girls as agents of change and centres their voices and leadership**
- **Economic justice, which calls for equal access to employment, resources, and social protection**
- **Political justice, which focuses on safe and equal participation in governance and decision-making**
- **Cultural justice, which addresses harmful norms and promotes shared responsibility, including engaging men and boys**
- **Digital justice, which ensures safe, equitable access to technology and addresses online violence and discrimination**

Strengthening Accountability and Action

The CSW70 priorities emphasise that acvhieving gender equality requires strong systems of accountability and implementation. They call for reforms that ensure laws, policies, and institutions effectively protect rights and deliver justice.

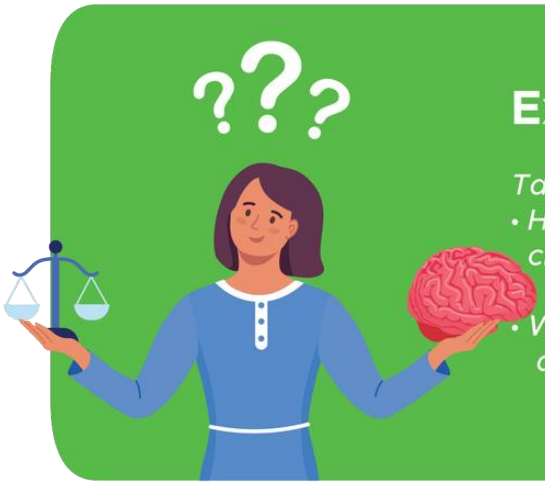
This includes strengthening governance systems, improving access to justice mechanisms, and ensuring that institutions are responsive to the needs of all women and girls. It also highlights the importance of adequate financing and efficient use of resources to sustain gender equality efforts.

This reinforces the importance of accountability frameworks, such as those discussed in the WPS-HA Compact, and the need for continuous monitoring and improvement.

Key Takeaway

The CSW70 priorities bring together the key lessons of this training by showing that gender equality depends on how effectively systems deliver justice in practice.

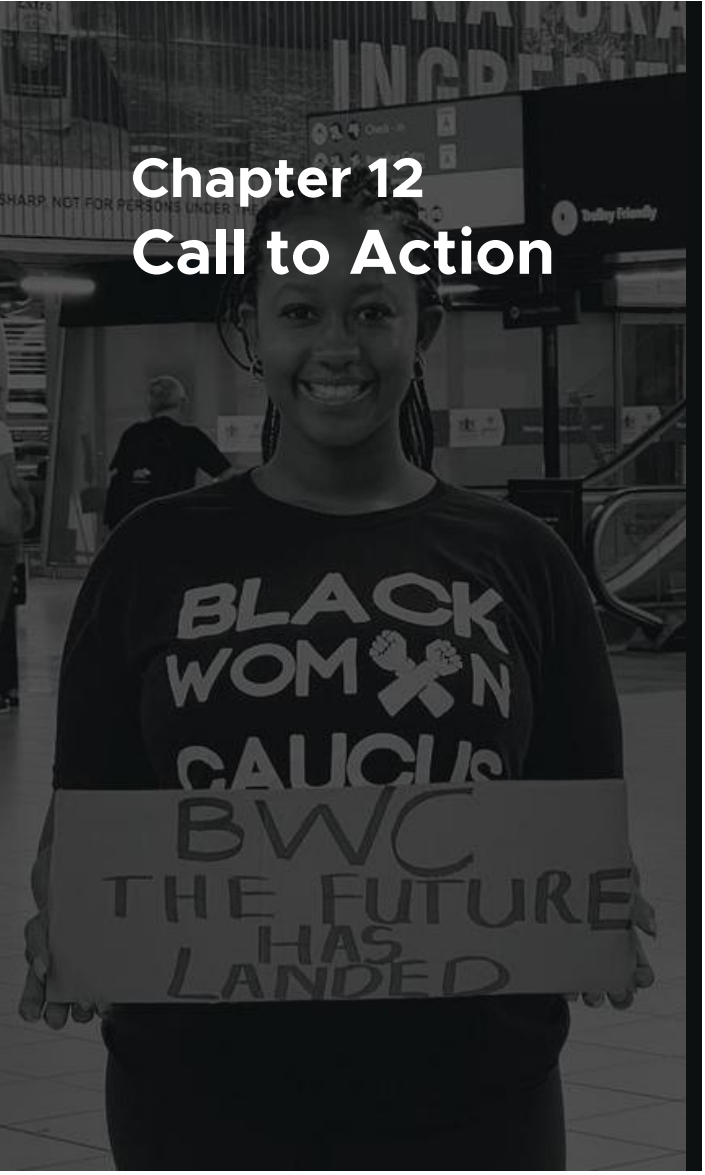
They emphasise the need to address structural barriers, strengthen accountability, and ensure that all women and girls are able to access their rights and participate fully in society.



Exercise

Take a moment to reflect:

- *How does understanding gender equality as access to justice change the way you think about the work BWC does?*
- *What is one barrier in your or BWC's context that limits women's and girls' access to justice, and how can it be addressed?*



Chapter 12
Call to Action

Coming to the conclusion of this training, a clear and consistent theme has taken shape. We have explored how global commitments on gender equality, from Beijing+30, the Generation Equality Forum, the Action Coalitions, the WPS-HA Compact, and the CSW70 priorities, are all aimed at one outcome: ensuring that women and girls experience real and meaningful change toward gender equality wherever they are in the world.

We began by understanding Beijing+30 as a review and acceleration moment that reflects on 30 years since the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action. It showed that while progress has been made, persistent gaps remain, and that gender equality requires stronger implementation, financing, accountability, youth inclusion, and action that responds to the lived realities of women and girls.

We then explored the Generation Equality Forum as a platform that helps move the gender equality agenda from commitments toward concrete, measurable action. Through financing, policy, advocacy, and programmatic commitments, the forum created a framework for collective action. The Action Coalitions were articulated as the main vehicles for this work, focusing on six critical areas: Feminist Movements and Leadership; Gender-Based Violence; Economic Justice and Rights; Bodily Autonomy and Sexual and Reproductive Health Rights; Feminist Action on Climate Action; and Technology and Innovation for Gender Equality. These show the importance of multilateralism in addressing gender equality and how multi-stakeholder partnerships can translate shared priorities to practical action.

The WPS-HA Compact further strengthens this focus on implementation and accountability by showing how existing commitments on women, peace and security and humanitarian action can be monitored and advanced in conflict and crisis contexts and pointed to an accountability framework for the action coalitions and thus generally for gender equality efforts by leaders, stakeholderholders and commitment markers. The UN CSW70 priorities then brought the discussion closer to everyday realities by showing that gender equality must also be understood through access to justice across social, economic, political, cultural, and digital spheres of life.

Therefore, the responsibility now is not to make more promises or commitments but to **strengthen how existing commitments are implemented, resourced, monitored, and experienced in "real life"** (i.e., in practice). This requires applying the reflections from this training within your own context by strengthening programmes, supporting women-led and youth-led initiatives, improving coordination, advocating for effective policy implementation, and addressing barriers that limit access to justice. In doing so, you can contribute to ensuring that gender equality is not only a stated commitment, but a lived reality for women and girls in all their diversity.

Amandla! Ngawthu! Power! It is ours! (Power! It is ours!)

Wathint' abafazi, wathint' imbokodo. (You strike a woman, you strike a rock).

Glossary Based on ref 10.2

Definitions and corresponding references are extracted from the "WOMEN, PEACE & SECURITY AND HUMANITARIAN ACTION COMPACT FRAMEWORK" document (pages 21-22).

Diversity refers to different values, attitudes, cultural perspectives, beliefs, ethnic backgrounds, nationalities, religions, sexual orientations, gender identities, abilities, health, social statuses, skills and other specific personal characteristics. Characteristics vary from person to person, and these differences must be recognized, understood and valued in each specific context and operation in order to ensure protection for all people. (UNHCR)

Gender refers to the socially-constructed differences between females and males — and the relationships between and among them — throughout their life cycle. They are context- and time-specific and change over time, within and across cultures. Gender, together with other characteristics including age, sexual orientation, gender identity, determines roles, responsibilities, power and access to resources. (ASC Gender Handbook in Humanitarian Action 2006)

Gender discrimination is any distinction, exclusion or restriction made on the ba sis of sex which has the effect or purpose of impairing or nullifying the recognition, enjoyment or exercise by women, irrespective of their marital status, on the basis of equality of men and women, of human rights and fundamental freedoms in the political, economic, social, cultural, civil or any other field. [United Nations, 1979. 'Convention on the Elimination of all forms of Discrimination Against Women'. Article 1] Discrimination can stem from both law (de jure) or from practice (de facto). The CEDAW Convention recognizes and addresses both forms of discrimination, whether contained in laws, policies, procedures or practice.

» De jure discrimination: E.g. In some countries, the law states that women (citizens) who marry foreign men lose their citizenship and/or property rights. On the other hand, men (citizens) married to foreigners do not lose their citizenship and/or property rights. (CEDAW)

» De facto discrimination: E.g. The practice of many immigration officials in various countries is to find a woman traveling alone with her minor children "suspicious" while men traveling with their children are seldom questioned. (CEDAW)

Gender equality refers to the equal rights, responsibilities and opportunities of women and men and girls and boys. Equality does not mean that women and men will become the same but that women's and men's rights, responsibilities and opportunities will not depend on whether they are born male or female. Gender equality implies that the interests, needs and priorities of both women and men are taken into consideration, recognizing the diversity of different groups of women and men. Gender equality is not a women's issue but should concern and fully engage men as well as women. Equality between women and men is seen both as a human rights issue and as a precondition for, and indicator of, sustainable people-centered development. (UN Women, OSAGI Gender Mainstreaming - Concepts and definitions)

Impact is defined as primary and secondary long-term effects produced by an intervention, directly or indirectly, intended or unintended. (OECD)

Intersectional (denoting intersectionality): An intersectional approach to promoting gender equality for women and girls in all their diversity includes a consideration of where gen der intersects with other inequalities and oppressions including those experienced because of; sexual orientation, gender identity, race, sex, age, ethnicity, indigeneity, migrant status, disability, religion, urban or rural status, HIV status, geographic location and other dimensions to produce unique experiences of violence. An intersectional approach goes beyond an idea of multiple forms of discrimination or oppression. Intersectionality adds to this by insisting that these oppressions cannot be viewed as additive, and that experiences of inequality must be contextualized within an understanding of simultaneous, intersecting inequalities. (based on UNW, "The Value of Intersectionality in Understanding Violence Against Women and Girls (VAWG)," 2019)

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